

Cindy Yu, MSc
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EDUCATION

- Master of Arts (MA), Clinical Psychology, Thesis** 2025 – present
 University of British Columbia (UBC), Vancouver, BC, Canada
 Master's Thesis (Working Title): Turning to AI in a Crisis: How Students Use Chatbots for Suicidal Ideation and Acute Distress (Supervisor: Dr. E. David Klonsky)
- Bachelor of Arts (BA), Psychology Major** 2023 – 2025
 UBC, Vancouver, BC, Canada
 Cumulative Average: 93.9%
- Master of Science (MSc) in Epidemiology, Thesis** 2017 – 2020
 University of Ottawa, Ottawa, ON, Canada
 Master's Thesis: The effects of long-term exposure to ambient fine particulate matter (PM_{2.5}) on the incidence of type 2 diabetes mellitus in a rural Chinese cohort (Supervisor: Dr. Yue Chen)
- Bachelor of Health Sciences (BHSc), Honours with Distinction** 2013 – 2017
 McMaster University, Hamilton, ON, Canada
 CGPA: 3.90/4.00
 Honours Thesis: The effect of epicardial adipose tissue on atrial fibrillation and its impact on ablation outcome (Supervisor: Dr. Benjamin Chow)

SELECTED AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- First Place 3MT Award for Responsible AI Track at Canadian AI 2026** 2026
- Second Place Poster Award for Responsible AI Track at Canadian AI 2026** 2026
- Registration Scholarship for Responsible AI Track at Canadian AI 2026** 2026
- SIPS Diversity Travel Grant (\$575 USD; ~\$787 CAD)** 2026
- Supports people from all career stages who are underrepresented in science, to attend the Society for Improvement of Psychological Science (SIPS) conference.
- 2025 Jean Pettifor and Dick Pettifor Fund Grant (\$10,000 CAD)** 2026
- Supports student research projects in professional ethics as related to the practice of psychology or general ethics in psychology.
- ABCT SSI SIG Travel Award (\$250 USD; ~\$345 CAD)** 2025
- Supports students to travel to present at the Suicide and Self Injury (SSI) Special Interest Group (SIG) Expo Night at the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies (ABCT) Conference.
- Canadian Graduate Scholarship-Master's (CGS M; \$27,000 CAD)** 2025
- Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada (SSHRC)
- Nationally competitive federal grant, awarded for demonstrating exceptional academic achievement, research potential, and leadership abilities.

Faculty of Arts Graduate Award (\$3,500 CAD) Faculty of Arts, UBC	2025
• Merit-based funding package awarded to support graduate research and academic excellence within the Faculty of Arts.	
Undergraduate Student Research Awards (USRA; est. \$6,000 CAD) Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada (NSERC)	2025
• Awarded to undergraduate students based on academic excellence, research potential, and the quality of mentorship, to nurture their interest in a research career and graduate school.	
Trek Excellence Scholarship for Continuing Students (\$1,500 CAD)	2024
• Awarded to domestic students in top 5% of their undergraduate year, faculty, and school.	
Undergraduate Student Research Awards (USRA; est. \$6,000 CAD) Natural Sciences and Engineering Research Council of Canada (NSERC)	2024
The Robert Spasoff Award (\$600 CAD) School of Epidemiology and Public Health (SEPH, University of Ottawa)	2020
• 1st place prize for oral presentation in MSc student category at SEPH Annual Student Research Day.	
Canada-China Scholars' Exchange Program, 2018–2019 (est. \$10,000 CAD) Jointly by Global Affairs Canada and the Chinese Ministry of Education	2019
• Scholarship to support Canadian students to pursue research in participating Chinese institutions.	
University of Ottawa Graduate Scholarship – Masters (\$30,000 CAD) University of Ottawa	2017 – 2019
• Scholarship for thesis-stream graduate student, given on recommendation of academic unit to student whose admission average is above 8.0/10.0 (80-100%).	

PUBLICATIONS

*Indicates these authors contributed equally to the work.

Peer-Reviewed Publications:

Ghogomu, E. T., Welch, V., Yaqubi, M., Dewidar, O., Barbeau, V., Dowling, S., Li, Y., Sabri, H., Elmestekawy, M., Aljufri, E., Aliyar, B., Pan, Y., Al Ameer, A., Al Zubaidi, A., Bondok, M., Kojan, W., Madani, M. T., Tong, K., Irefin, A., **Yu, C.**, ... Hébert, P. (2026). Effects of Social Prescribing for Older Adults: An Evidence and Gap Map. *Campbell Systematic Reviews*, 22(2), 18911803261435893. <https://doi.org/10.1177/18911803261435893>

Yu, C., Muratov, M., Mulligan, K., Welch, V., Nelson, M. L. A., Hebert, P., Biswas, S., Hsiung, S., & Card, K. G. (2025). The Importance of Trust Among Older Adults Throughout the Social Prescribing Pathway: A Mixed-Methods Analysis. *International Journal of Community Well-Being*. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s42413-025-00268-x>

Yu, C., Lail, S., Allison, S., Biswas, S., Hebert, P., Hsiung, S., Mulligan, K., Nelson, M. L. A., Saragosa, M., Welch, V., & Card, K. G. (2024). Social Prescribing Needs and Priorities of Older Adults in Canada: A Qualitative Analysis. *Health Promotion and Chronic Disease Prevention in Canada: Research, Policy and Practice*, 44(9) (September 2024). <https://doi.org/10.24095/hpcdp.44.9.03>

Ghogomu, E. T., Welch, V., Yaqubi, M., Dewidar, O., Barbeau, V. I., Biswas, S., Card, K., Hsiung, S., Muhl, C., Nelson, M., Salzwedel, D. M., Saragosa, M., **Yu, C.**, Mulligan, K., & Hébert, P. (2024). PROTOCOL: Effects of social prescribing for older adults: An evidence and gap map. *Campbell Systematic Reviews*, 20(2), e1382. <https://doi.org/10.1002/cl2.1382>

Yu, C.* & Matz, C.* (2022). Lung cancer and ambient PM_{2.5} in Canada: a systematic review and meta-analysis (Cat. No. H144-98/2022E-PDF). *Health Canada*. Available from: publications.gc.ca/pub?id=9.907038&sl=0

Yu, C.*, Matz, C.*, & Seenundun, S.* (2022). Traffic-related air pollution: an umbrella review-based human health risk assessment on selected cancer types (Cat. No. H144-97/2022E-PDF). *Health Canada*. Available from: publications.gc.ca/pub?id=9.907034&sl=0

Non-Peer Reviewed Publications:

Yu, C., Lail, S., Frost, A., & Card, K.G. (2024). Evidence Brief – Do pets help with loneliness? *Canadian Alliance for Social Connection and Health*. Available from: https://casch.org/s/CSCG_Evidence-Brief_Pets.pdf

Yu, C., Muratov, M., & Card, K. G. (2023). Social Prescribing Needs of Older Adults in Canada: Baseline Quantitative Report. *Canadian Alliance for Social Connection and Health*. Available from: <https://casch.org/s/CISP-Baseline-Report.pdf>

Yu, C.*, Seenundun, S.*, Matz, C.J.*, & Stieb, D.M.* (2022). Comment on: Han K, Ran Z, Wang X, Wu Q, Zhan N, Yi Z, Jin T. Traffic-related organic and inorganic air pollution and risk of development of childhood asthma: A meta-analysis. *Environ Res*. 2021;194:110493. doi: 10.1016/j.envres.2020.110493. *Environmental Research*, 214(Pt 3), 113922. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.envres.2022.113922>

Yu, C. (2020). Effect of Long-Term Exposure to Ambient Fine Particulate Matter (PM_{2.5}) on the Incidence of Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus (T2DM): A Cohort Study in Rural China [Master's thesis, University of Ottawa]. *uO Research*. Available from: <http://dx.doi.org/10.20381/ruor-25416>

PRESENTATIONS

*Indicates these authors contributed equally to the work.

Oral Conference Presentations:

Yu, C., Dosso, J., & Klonsky E.D. (2026, May 26). *Turning to AI in a Crisis: A Mixed-Methods Study Proposal on Chatbot Use for Support during Distress and Suicidal Ideation* [Oral presentation]. 39th Canadian Conference on Artificial Intelligence's Responsible AI Track, Vancouver, BC, Canada. ***
First Place 3MT Award***

Yu, C. (2025, April 4, 7). *Meaning in Suffering: Analysis of Dostoevsky's Crime and Punishment* [Oral presentation]. UBC Slavic Studies' Timeless Literary Legacies Conference: Experiencing Eastern Europe, Vancouver, BC, Canada.

Yu, C. (2024, June 21-23). *The Role of Autonomy and Threats to Autonomy in Perceiving Benefits and Effectiveness of Social Prescribing for Older Adults* [Oral presentation]. Canadian Psychological Association's (CPA) 85th Annual National Convention, Ottawa, ON, Canada.

Yu, C. (2024, April 23-25). *A Tension of Trust for Older Adults with Their Healthcare Providers: Implications for Social Prescribing and other Health Programming* [Oral presentation]. Health Quality BC (HQBC) Quality Forum 2024, Vancouver, BC, Canada.

Yu, C. (2023, November 21-22). *Social Prescribing for Older Adults in Canada: Their Needs, Priorities, and Digital Considerations* [Oral presentation]. 2023 Public Health Association of British Columbia (PHABC) Conference on Public Health and Equity in the Digital Age, Vancouver, BC, Canada.

Yu, C. (2023, October 17-18). *Social Prescribing: What are Older Adults' Attitudes and Beliefs?* [Oral presentation]. Canadian Human Connection Conference, Toronto, ON, Canada.

Yu, C., & Matz, C. (2022, February 14-18). *Lung Cancer and Ambient PM_{2.5} in Canada: A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis* [Oral presentation]. Health Canada Science Forum, Ottawa, ON, Canada.

Yu, C., Liu C., Kan H., Chen Y., & Fu, C. (2020, February 5). *The effects of long-term exposure to ambient fine particulate matter (PM_{2.5}) on the incidence of type 2 diabetes mellitus in a rural Chinese cohort* [Oral presentation], Annual School of Epidemiology and Public Health (SEPH) Research Day, University of Ottawa, Ottawa, ON, Canada. *****Winner of The Robert Spasoff Award*****

Poster Conference Presentations:

Yu, C. & Rights, J. (2026, June 22-24). *Multilevel Modeling Reporting Practices of Intensive Longitudinal Data in Clinical Psychology: A Methodological Review and Tutorial* [Conference poster accepted but could not attend]. 2026 Modern Modeling Methods (M3) Conference, New York City, NY, USA.

Yu, C. & Rights, J. (2026, June 8-10). *Multilevel Modeling Reporting Practices of Intensive Longitudinal Data in Clinical Psychology: A Methodological Review and Tutorial* [Conference poster]. 2026 Meeting of the Society for the Improvement of Psychological Science (SIPS), Arlington, Virginia, USA. *****Winner of the Diversity Travel Grant*****

Tarik, L., Hong, S., Yu, C., Arguelles, F., Chi, X., & LeMoult, J. (2026, May 28-30). *Does Self-Compassion Buffer the Effect of Acculturative Stress on Depressive symptoms Across Cultural Groups?* [Conference poster]. Association for Psychological Science (APS) Annual Convention, Barcelona, Spain.

Yu, C., Dosso, J., & Klonsky E.D. (2026, May 27). *Turning to AI in a Crisis: A Mixed-Methods Study Proposal on Chatbot Use for Support during Distress and Suicidal Ideation* [Conference poster]. 39th Canadian Conference on Artificial Intelligence's Responsible AI Track, Vancouver, BC, Canada. *****Second Place Poster Award*****

Yu, C., Dosso, J., & Klonsky E.D. (2026, May 1-2). *Turning to AI in a Crisis: A Study Protocol on How Students Use Chatbots for Suicidal Ideation and Acute Distress* [Conference poster]. 16th Annual Canadian Association of Cognitive and Behavioural Therapies (CACBT) Conference, Vancouver, BC, Canada.

Yu, C., Shahnaz, A., Pachkowski, M., & Klonsky E.D. (2026, April 15-17). *Interoceptive Awareness and Suicide Cognitions: Testing Emotion Dysregulation Mediation and PTSD Moderation* [Conference poster]. Suicide Research Symposium (SRS), Online.

Yu, C., Shahnaz, A., Klonsky E.D. (2025, November 20-23). *Which Emotion Dynamics Predict Concurrent Suicide Ideation? An Ecological Momentary Assessment of High-Risk Young Adults* [Conference poster]. Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies (ABCT) Special Interest Group (SIG) in Suicide and Self Injury (SSI) Exposition, New Orleans, LA, USA. *****Winner of SSI SIG Travel Award*****

Hong, S., Arguelles, F., **Yu, C.**, & LeMoult, J. (2025, September 25-28). *The Moderating Role of Parenting in the Link between Acculturative Stress and Anxiety: A Study among Chinese Heritage University Students in Canada* [Conference poster]. Society for Research in Psychopathology (SRP) Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA, USA. *****Winner of EDI Poster Award*****

Yu, C., Arguelles, F., Chi, X., & LeMoult, J. (2024, October 17-20). *Comparing the Relation between Self-Conscious Moral Emotions (Shame and Guilt), and Depressive Symptoms in Chinese, Chinese Canadian, and Caucasian Canadian Students: A Longitudinal Cross-Cultural Study* [Conference poster]. Society for Research in Psychopathology (SRP) 2024 Annual Meeting, Montreal, QC, Canada.

Arguelles, F., **Yu, C.**, & LeMoult, J. (2024, October 17-20). *The Impacts of Cultural Stress on Depression Symptomology: A Longitudinal Comparison of Domestic and International Chinese Students* [Conference poster]. Society for Research in Psychopathology (SRP) 2024 Annual Meeting, Montreal, QC, Canada.

Yu, C.*, Arguelles, F.*, Chi, X., & LeMoult, J. (2024, April 5-6). *Differences in Depression, Anxiety and Contributing Psychological Factors among Young Adults from Chinese, Chinese Canadian, and Canadian Backgrounds: A Study Proposal* [Conference poster]. 26th Annual Psychology Undergraduate Research Conference (PURC), Vancouver, BC, Canada.

Arguelles, F.*, & **Yu, C.***, & LeMoult, J. (2024, April 5-6). *Cultural Stress and Depression: A Comparative Study Among Chinese Domestic and International Students* [Conference poster]. 26th Annual Psychology Undergraduate Research Conference (PURC), Vancouver, BC, Canada.

Yu, C., & Matz, C. (2022, February 14-18). *Lung Cancer and Ambient PM_{2.5} in Canada: A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis* [Conference poster]. Health Canada Science Forum, Ottawa, ON, Canada

Shimbori, C., **Yu, C.**, Parthasarathy, P., Bellaye, P.S., Sato, S., Upagupta, C., Ask, K., Gauldie, J., Bowdish, D. & Kolb, M. (2017). *Silica-Induced Pulmonary Fibrosis Occurs with the Activation of Macrophage Polarization Through MARCO and in a TGF- β 1-Independent Manner*. In: *Regulatory Mechanisms of the Molecular Pathways in Fibrosis* (p. A2469–A2469). American Thoracic Society.

Invited Talks:

Yu, C.*, Wadman, A.*, & Card, K. G. (2024, March 27). *Social Prescribing for Older Adults: Priority Population Research Findings* [Invited webinar]. Social Prescribing Research Seminar Series, Canadian Institute for Social Prescribing (CISP), ON, Canada. (60+ attendees)

Yu, C.*, & Card, K. G.* (2023, June 20). *Social Prescribing and Why It's Needed* [Invited webinar]. Seniors Care Health Learning Series, Island Health, BC, Canada. (50+ attendees)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student

2025 – present

Personality, Emotion, and Behaviour Lab (PEBL), UBC

PI: Dr. E. David Klonsky, PhD

- Conceptualizing, developing, and leading an exploratory mixed-methods study on how young adults use AI chatbots for emotional distress and suicidal ideation.
- Conducted a psychometric validation study of the Multidimensional Emotion Questionnaire using confirmatory factor analysis (CFA) to evaluate structural validity.
- Analyzed an ecological momentary assessment (EMA) study to examine real-time co-occurrence of discrete emotions and emotion dynamic indices with suicidal ideation.

Research Assistant (NSERC USRA-funded)

2025

Rights Lab, UBC

PI: Dr. Jason Rights, PhD

- Conducted a methodological review on reporting practices in multilevel modeling of intensive longitudinal data in clinical psychology.

Research Assistant (NSERC USRA-funded)

2024 – 2025

Structural Equation Modelling (SEM) Lab, UBC

PI: Dr. Victoria Savalei, PhD

- Compared latent interaction approaches in structural equation modeling (SEM), running simulations and applying distribution analytic approaches using R (lavaan, simsem).

Study Coordinator and Senior Research Assistant

2023 – 2025

Depression, Anxiety, and Stress (DAS) Lab, UBC

PI: Dr. Joelle LeMoult, PhD, R. Psych

- Managed full life-cycle of longitudinal studies, including ethics approvals, Qualtrics/ExpiWell programming, Ecological Momentary Assessment (EMA) data collection, and data cleaning/analysis in R.

Social Epidemiologist & Research Coordinator

2022 – 2024

Healthy Ecologies and Lifestyles Lab, Simon Fraser University

PI: Dr. Kiffer Card, PhD

- Led mixed-methods research on social prescribing needs for older adults, conducting statistical analyses in R, thematic analysis in NVivo, and facilitating focus groups.

Scientific Evaluator

2019 – 2022

Healthy Environments and Consumer Safety Branch, Health Canada

- Developed and executed literature search and screening, assessed risk of bias, performed pooled, sensitivity, and subgroup analyses in R to collaboratively design epidemiology-based risk assessments.

Master's Thesis Student

2017 – 2020

University of Ottawa

PI: Dr. Yue Chen, PhD, MD

- Implemented Cox proportional hazards regression and complex exposure modeling (e.g., constituent-residual models) using SAS to examine the effects of air pollution on health outcomes.

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Volunteer Hand in Hand Mentor

2024 – 2025

The Looking Glass Foundation for Eating Disorders

- Delivered support and a listening ear in a one-on-one, long-term relationship with individuals with eating disorders.

Volunteer Crisis Services Responder

2022 – 2023

The Crisis Intervention and Suicide Prevention Centre of British Columbia

- Delivered emotional support and crisis intervention through phone calls and online chats, navigating a wide range of crises and distress.

Focus Group Facilitator

2022 – 2023

Healthy Ecologies and Lifestyles Lab, Simon Fraser University

- Facilitated focus groups with socially marginalized and structurally disadvantaged older adults with intersectional lived experience, including low income, those living alone, disability status, ethnicity, sexual orientation.

Volunteer Peer Supporter

2022 – 2023

Alma Mater Society Peer Support, UBC

- Delivered confidential, one-on-one peer support to the UBC student population, addressing a range of emotional, psychological, stressful challenges, with training for student-specific issues, such as academic stress, burnout, and loneliness.

VOLUNTEER & LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant (TA)

2026

Introductory Psychology, UBC

EDI Working Group Member

2025 – present

Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion (EDI) Hiring Committee Member, UBC

- Evaluate departmental hiring policies to support equitable recruitment practices.
- Assess evolving perspectives and narratives on the use of EDI statements across North America.

EDI Student Mentor

2025 – present

Diversity Mentorship Program, UBC

- Provide targeted mentorship, academic guidance, and professional development support to students from under-resourced and marginalized backgrounds.

Volunteer Dog Walker

2022 – present

ElderDog Canada

- Provide weekly dog walking support, specifically offering services to vulnerable populations with physical or cognitive limitations and disabilities.

Executive & Regional Committee Member

2022 – 2023

Young Professionals Network, Health Canada and Public Health Agency of Canada

- Managed large-scale professional development initiatives, serving as the primary point of contact for senior branch leadership.